THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 08

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Yoga: A Gift from Ancient India

The word 'yoga' comes from a Sanskrit word meaning 'to join'. It is an ancient system that joins the body, the mind and the breath. Although it has been practised in India for thousands of years, it has become popular all over the world, and every year on 21 June, countries celebrate International Yoga Day.

A typical yoga session has three parts. The first is asana, or posture. Poses such as the mountain pose, the tree pose and the cobra pose stretch the muscles, strengthen the back and make the body flexible. The second is pranayama, or breath control, in which the practitioner breathes slowly and deeply in a set pattern. The third is meditation, in which the mind is calmed and the attention rests on a single point, such as the breath.

The benefits of regular practice are many. Doctors say that yoga can improve posture, reduce stress and help people sleep better. Students who practise it often find that they can concentrate longer and feel less anxious about examinations. Unlike many sports, yoga needs no expensive equipment, only a mat and a quiet corner, and it can be practised by young and old alike.

It is wise, however, to learn yoga from a trained teacher, because wrong postures can cause injury. A beginner should never force the body into a pose, but should move gently and stop when there is pain. Like all good habits, yoga needs patience. The results do not come in a day, but those who practise daily soon notice that they feel lighter, calmer and happier.

(i) The word 'yoga' means: 1

(a) to breathe **(b)** to join **(c)** to rest **(d)** to run

(ii) International Yoga Day is celebrated on: 1

(a) 2 October **(b)** 5 June **(c)** 15 August **(d)** 21 June

(iii) Pranayama refers to: 1

(a) diet **(b)** meditation

(c) breath control **(d)** posture

(iv) One advantage of yoga over many sports is that it: 1

(a) needs no expensive equipment **(b)** is played outdoors

(c) is a team game **(d)** is faster

(v) A beginner should: 1

(a) avoid a teacher **(b)** stop when there is pain

(c) practise only once a month **(d)** force the body into poses

(vi) State whether True or False: Yoga has been practised only for the last few years. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Name the three parts of a yoga session. 1

(viii) How can yoga help students? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'bending and flexible'. 1

(x) Why should a beginner learn from a trained teacher? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Night of the Power Cut

It was the first week of May and Jaipur was burning. At half past eight on Thursday evening, just as Nisha had opened her mathematics book, the lights flickered, the fan stopped whirring and the whole house sank into darkness. "Power cut again," groaned her brother Kabir.

Their mother brought out two candles and set them on the dining table. "No television, no phones," she announced, for the batteries had to be saved. "We shall have a family evening." Kabir rolled his eyes. Nisha secretly rather liked the idea.

At first there was silence. The candles hissed, and moths fluttered round the flames. Then their grandmother, who was sitting by the window, began to tell a story. It was about a clever crow who dropped pebbles into a pitcher to raise the water level. "I've heard that a hundred times," muttered Kabir. "Then tell one of your own," Grandmother said calmly.

To everyone's surprise, Kabir did. He told of a boy who found a magic torch which turned everything it lit into gold, and by the end of it the whole family was laughing. Father played a game of riddles and Mother sang an old folk song. For the first time in months, nobody looked at a screen.

When the lights came back at eleven, no one moved to switch them on. "Let us have the candles a little longer," said Kabir. Nisha smiled in the dark. She had never thought a power cut could be so bright.

(i) The power cut began at: 1

(a) half past eight **(b)** six

(c) noon **(d)** eleven

(ii) Mother said there would be no television or phones because: 1

(a) it was a holiday **(b)** she disliked them

(c) the batteries had to be saved **(d)** they were broken

(iii) Grandmother's story was about: 1

(a) a monkey **(b)** a king

(c) a magic torch **(d)** a clever crow

(iv) 'She had never thought a power cut could be so bright' is an example of: 1

(a) a contrast (paradox) **(b)** a question

(c) a pun on names **(d)** a rhyme

(v) The family enjoyed the evening because: 1

(a) they spent time together without screens **(b)** they watched a film

(c) guests came **(d)** the lights stayed off all night

(vi) State whether True or False: Kabir refused to tell any story. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Why did Kabir roll his eyes at the 'family evening' idea? 1

(viii) What did Mother do during the evening? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'moved lightly and quickly'. 1

(x) Why did nobody switch on the lights at eleven? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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